

USUCGER Annual Meeting

MINUTES

Sunday March 20, 2022

3:00 PM Eastern Time

Adda Athanasopoulos-Zekkos, USUCGER President, Presiding

Attendance:

- Adda Athanasopoulos-Zekkos (President), Joseph Coe (Treasurer), Scott Olson (Past President), Kristin Sample-Lord (Webmaster), Alesandra Morales, Matt Evans, Jack Montgomery, and Bret Lingwall (Secretary).
- Also, in attendance were 28 unique USUCGER members attended for at least 30 minutes

Welcome:

- Call to Order at 3:03 PM
- Introductions of all the board members

General Committee Business:

- Adda has been extended President for one additional year. New president election to come fall of 2023.
- NSF program director meeting with Giovanna Biscontin
- Student travel grants – 4 were awarded. Revitalized the program and interest was strong from students.

Treasurer's Report:

- Current financial status was presented to the membership (\$43,000+)
- Current commitments for expenditures are the student travel grants to be done as reimbursements
- New dues drive started Feb 2022. Dues drive will kick into gear in April 2022. A 6-month grace period before membership privileges are withdrawn.
- Tong and Joseph have seamlessly transitioned the treasurer's responsibilities
- Much of the funds are earmarked for the 2022 young investigator workshop to be held at UT Austin.

Webmaster's Report:

- New website is live and operational.
- Dues collection is now automated and part of the new website. The payments still link through Pay-Pal.
 - If a PO or check is required for payment by institution, use the PO option and reach out to Joe to get a coupon code for entry into the payment website.
- A web developer was paid by USUCGER funds to support the new website.
- Hosting videos on the website takes a lot of space. A USUCGER YouTube channel was set up as an alternative so that we don't have to host the videos and pay for space.
 - Please send content for the USUCGER channel (teaching resources) to the board.

- Please add teaching tools to the website by contacting the webmaster for materials that can be shared.

Additional Business:

- GI and Geo-Coalition Updates
 - 2023 ADSC scholarship call was issued in March 2022. There has been a decline in applicants, so please send the call for scholarships to students.
 - ADSC and DFI will be funding more research projects, and look for calls for research to come from ADSC and DFI relevant to the drilled shaft industry.
 - ADSC has started a workforce development program in Texas. Would like to expand nationally to other areas outside of Texas. Need to bring together University students and tech school students (designers and fabricators)..... bringing the two sides together as students.
 - IFCEE 2024 will be a little different for Dallas.... The technical program will be different than a conventional paper approach, with technology demonstrations of research advancements, full-scale, at the conference.
 - GeoCongress 2026 in Washington DC could be the host of the ICSMGE conference. Hosting competition is underway for both GeoCongress and the ICSMGE.
 - What is the best way for promoting AGP? How can we get D.GE on student radar as the next step after PE licensure?
 - Special projects budget through GI technical committees have been increased by 30% this year thanks to the financial health of GI. This is enabled by the robust conference attendance for GI conferences
 - 350 students here at GeoCongress 2023. The USUCGER membership plays a key role in continued GI involvement and participation by recent graduates.
 - Please communicate ideas for helping keep new grads engaged with GI to GI... there are funds available for such initiatives if successfully proposed
- Special projects update
 - New RFP to be released in Fall 2022 for 2023.
 - 2021 Grant – Dr. Daniel Vanderburg at Tennessee Tech
 - Use of CAT-Apps for geotechnical instruction. Presentation was given.
 - Please see the USUCGER website for the instructional tools.
- Awards
 - Early Career Educator Awards
 - Inaugural recipients were James Kaklamanos of Merrimack College and Cassandra Rutherford of Iowa State University
 - DEI Award
 - Inaugural recipients are Chris Swan of Tufts University and Andrea Welker of Villanova University
- Early career workshop to be hosted in September 2022 at UT Austin. Details to come to the USUCGER membership in May or June of 2022 once funding is finalized.
- Mentoring Initiative and Associated Ad-hoc Committee
 - Mentoring initiative has been initiated, led by Matt Evans.
 - New hires in the COVID era are in particular need to mentoring and networking

- An online meeting was held Feb 2. A ~quarterly mentoring session is being arranged for the group.

Questions and Comments from the Membership:

- A USUCGER subcommittee was proposed by Scott Olson for JEDI initiatives with resources attached to further the effort.
 - A particular area of emphasis could be the African American students at a national level. The “pie” of talented students needs to grow.
- USUCGER strategic plan has not been updated for many years. The strategic plan should be updated to include JEDI. Proposed by Jack Montgomery, who also volunteered for the effort to update the strategic plan.
- DFI has mentoring pods for their mentoring program. USUCGER can consider setting up a pod system for the sustained mentoring program. These pods consist of 5 to 8 individuals.
- One of the coming problems is increasing marginalization of geotechnical engineering. How will USUCGER help lead into a future and help de-marginalize geotechnical engineering in both academia and the marketplace.
 - Are there national curricula recommendations and standards to help individual institutions and departments in their strategic planning?
 - Data science and Data-Driven Decision Making is replacing many field or supplanting them. National perspectives on how to implement in geotechnical and other civil curricula would be of great import to many departments and programs.

Adjourn at 4:35 PM after a Motion and Second